New York Electorate — Five Party-Resolved Cuts

Follow-on analyses, 2026-06-29, all from `scripts/diag_ny_electorate_extras.py` against `data/ny_vrdb.duckdb` (voters, voter_participation) + `data/ny_statewide.duckdb` (voter_donor_affiliation, forecast_predictions). Companion to `ny-turnout-by-party-age.md`, `donor-class-and-the-electorate.md` Finding 3, and `donor-class-and-the-electorate.md`.

> **Donor cuts here are on the POOLED, all-tier match — superseded for publication (noted 2026-07-28).** `diag_ny_electorate_extras.py` reads `voter_donor_affiliation`, which stacks federal and state giving into one donor total, and these figures predate the 2026-07-27 full-name-key switch. So the competitiveness numbers below (Tossup 57.7%, Solid 71.6%, 205K of 308K) are **not** the paper's. `donor-class-and-the-electorate.md` recomputes them per panel: federal Tossup **58.7%** / Solid **72.6%** with 177,918 of 269,218 in Solid districts, state 51.3% / 66.9% with 233,275 of 378,383. Quote the paper, not this file, and never compare a figure here to a panel-scoped one. Retained as the record of what that script currently outputs.

---

1. The unaffiliated "blank" bloc is young, disengaged, and donor-light

> **Superseded for publication (noted 2026-08-13).** The 2024-turnout column below was computed on the whole active roll, which counts registrants enrolled *after* the 2024 general as non-voters — the same denominator defect the paper's §III carried until 2026-08-11 and its §II until 2026-08-13. `diag_ny_electorate_extras.py` now denominates that column on registrants enrolled on or before the election; `who-decides-new-york.md` §II carries the corrected, pinned-roll figures (DEM 60.5% / REP 70.8% / NOPARTY 53.1%). Quote the paper, not this file.

NY's 25% no-party enrollment is the recurring blind spot of registration-based analysis. Characterized against the major parties (active roll):

party	roll %	median age	%65+	%18-29	2024 turnout	donors/1k
DEM	47.7%	49	26.7%	17.3%	58.4%	33.0
REP	22.7%	55	30.6%	14.0%	**69.5%**	23.6
NOPARTY	25.1%	**42**	17.7%	**24.0%**	**50.4%**	**12.5**

The unaffiliated bloc is the **youngest** (median 42 vs DEM 49, REP 55), the **least likely to vote** (50.4% in a presidential year vs 69.5% for Republicans), and the **least likely to donate** (12.5 matched federal donors per 1,000 vs 33.0 for Democrats). It is not a bloc of high-information independents holding the balance — it is a younger, more disengaged quarter of the roll. (Republicans are the oldest and highest-turnout group.)

2. The donor class is more Democratic than the electorate in *every* competitiveness band

Mapping each matched donor to their congressional district's competitiveness (from `forecast_predictions` |margin|):

CD band	donors	%DEM	%REP	%NOPARTY	(registrant %DEM)
Tossup (<5)	17,878	57.7%	23.5%	14.6%	(40%)
Lean (5–10)	16,467	45.9%	32.6%	16.3%	(31%)
Likely (10–20)	68,341	41.7%	38.8%	14.8%	(33%)
Solid (20+)	**205,346**	71.6%	14.5%	11.3%	(56%)

Two findings: (1) the donor pool's %DEM **exceeds registration in every band** (e.g. Solid: 71.6% donor vs 56% registrant; Tossup 57.7% vs 40%) — the donor class is more Democratic than the electorate everywhere, not just in blue districts. (2) **The overwhelming majority of donors live in Solid districts** (205K of 308K, mostly Solid-D Manhattan), so campaign money originates in safe seats and flows out — consistent with the cross-state finding that safe seats *supply* most money even as competitive ones receive a premium.

3. The gray off-year electorate is behavior, not rolls — and most so for Republicans

Das-Gupta two-factor decomposition of the change in each party's 65+ electorate share, 2024 presidential → 2025 off-year (rate = differential turnout; composition = registration age structure):

party	65+ share (pres)	65+ share (off)	observed change	RATE effect	COMP effect
DEM	29.0%	32.1%	+3.2	**+2.5**	+0.7
REP	32.7%	42.8%	+10.2	**+8.7**	+1.5
NOPARTY	22.4%	30.6%	+8.2	**+7.5**	+0.6

For every party the **rate effect dominates composition ~5–6×**: the off-year electorate is older because the young *choose not to vote off-cycle*, not because the rolls are differently composed. This is the institutional, on-cycle-timing- fixable diagnosis — and it is **strongest for Republicans**, whose electorate ages +10.2 points off-cycle (almost entirely behavior).

4. Recent registration cohorts are choosing no party — a secular shift to "blank"

Party mix and age of each year's *registration cohort* still on the roll — the people whose registration record carries that year:

reg year	new regs	%DEM	%REP	%NOPARTY	median age at reg
2004	432,683	51.5%	21.5%	21.6%	30
2008	559,590	57.8%	16.2%	20.7%	29
2012	508,663	57.0%	15.5%	22.6%	29
2016	785,520	51.5%	18.5%	25.6%	30
2020	903,928	40.9%	21.3%	33.7%	30
2024	893,119	**39.7%**	22.1%	**35.6%**	29

Records dated 2024 carry a Democratic share **~18 points** lower than those dated 2008 (57.8% → 39.7%) and a no-party share **~15 points** higher (20.7% → 35.6%); the Republican share is **~6 points** higher, monotonically. Median age at the recorded date is a stable ~29–30. **Read this as a description of the current roll by most-recent registration-event date.** *(Rewritten 2026-08-16, matching the correction made in `who-decides-new-york.md` §V and in the Idaho paper before it.)* The previous wording — that the unaffiliated bloc is "growing through new registration, a leading indicator that the snapshot electorate understates" — treated these rows as successive intakes of first-time registrants, which the caveat directly below has said they are not since 2026-08-11. The cross-sectional fact stands; the leading-indicator inference does not follow from it. (Caveat: survivorship — only registrants still on the current roll appear, so older cohorts are thinned by moves/purges; read the *trend in party mix*, which is composition-based, as the robust cut.)

"Cohort" ≠ "first-time registrant" (clarified 2026-08-11). `registration_date` is the most recent registration transaction, so a move, name change or party change can write a new date. Measured by the exact test — a cohort member who voted *before* their own registration date was registered earlier — at least 9.96% of the 2020 cohort and 13.91% of the 2024 cohort are re-registrations. Those two figures are **not comparable to each other**: 2024 has an eight-year detection window against 2020's four, and 2004–2016 cannot be tested at all because this file's vote history begins in 2016. Re-registrants are more Democratic and less unaffiliated than the rest of their cohort, so the contamination *understates* the trend above rather than manufacturing it. Full treatment in the paper's §V.

5. The New York registration map

District counts by registration lean (DEM% − REP%, active roll), on **symmetric** bands — the same 40+ / 20–40 / 5–20 / ±5 cut on each side, matching `who-decides-idaho.md` §IV:

Congressional (26): D+40+ **9** · D+20–40 **3** · D+5–20 **7** · within ±5 **4** · R+5–20 **3** · R+20–40 **0** · R+40+ **0**.

Assembly (150): D+40+ **55** · D+20–40 **31** · D+5–20 **19** · within ±5 **17** · R+5–20 **21** · R+20–40 **7** · R+40+ **0**.

By registration alone, **only 21 of 176 congressional and Assembly districts are within five points**; 19/26 and 105/150 lean Democratic, and **no district at either level is R+40**.

Corrected 2026-08-11. The bands were asymmetric — 40+/20–40/5–20 on the Democratic side against 5–20/20+ on the Republican — so a D+25 district was labelled "Likely D" while an R+25 was labelled "Safe R", and the seven Assembly seats shown as "Safe R" are R+20–40. The underlying counts are unchanged. Also withdrawn: the sentence that read the map as making "the general election a foregone conclusion" which "throws the real decision" to the primary. Registration is not a vote result, the dominant party's primary may itself be uncontested, and the companion safe-seat paper withdrew a stronger form of this inference on observed margins — better evidence than registration.

This is the registration-side corroboration of the observed safe-seat map (`safe-seat-washington.md`): a structural proxy for where a general election is likely to be one-sided, not a measurement of where seats are decided.

Reproduce

```
STATE=NY python scripts/diag_ny_electorate_extras.py
```

Caveats carried from the source memos: turnout *rates* use a current-roll denominator (survivorship-biased for older cycles; composition shares are robust); the donor match is a conservative name+ZIP proxy (a floor); CD competitiveness is the model's predicted margin, not a certified result.